Without Words

WORK: **Generative Design**
Synesthesia
Publication design
Digital fabrication (laser cutting)
Typography
Print
Book binding

DATE: 2026

This work is explores the translatation of sound into other formats. The form of the book and its content resulted from a generative procedure which relies on translating emotion experienced by the designer while listening to sound or a sample of music, then translating that emotion into a format which an audience outside of the self can get to experience without listening to the orginal sound sample. The publication uses minimal written language to guide the reader through the experience of the book, yet without using strongly-suggestive words that may point to the original emotion. I did this to test the efficacy of my synesthetic generative procedure. The original song was *This is What Falling in Love Feels Like* by JVKE, which carried emotional tonality similar to that one might feel when spring finally comes after a long winter.



















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Without Words, 2026















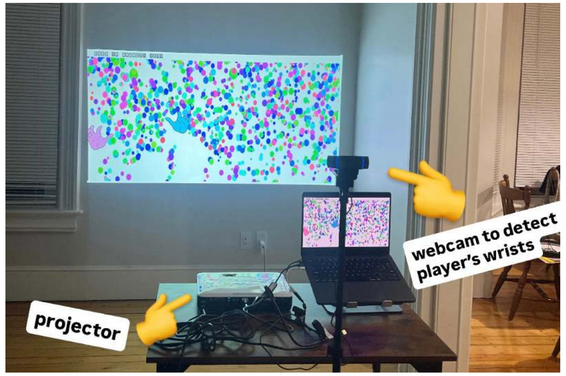
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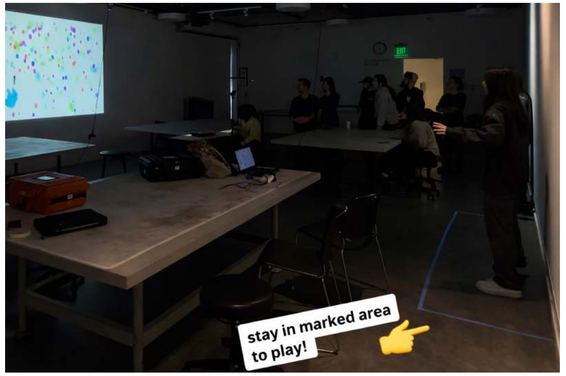
Catch the Eggs!

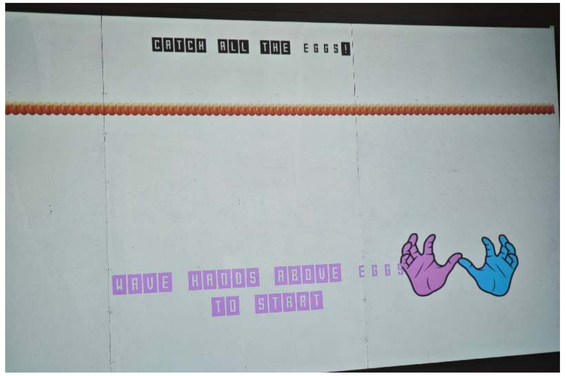
WORK: **Scripting + Systems thinking**
Experiential + interactive design
Creative coding
Spatial design
Game design
Generative design
Sound + installation
Audience engagement

DATE: 2026

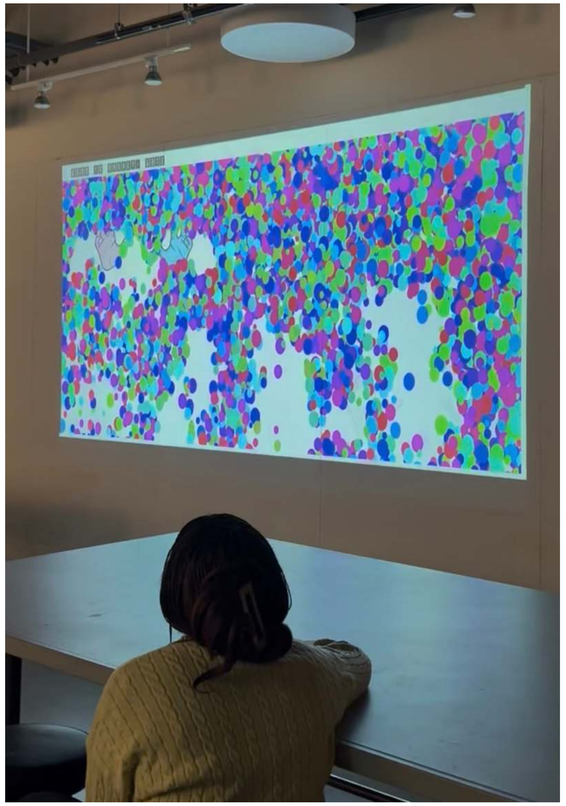
Catch the Eggs! is a game which derives body-pose code from ml5.js to create an interactive system that blurs the bridge between digital and physical, spatial experience by engaging the whole body. Constructed entirely in p5.js, 'Catch the Eggs!' uses variables, conditionals, interactivity, basic math functions, state-based logic, and animation via loops, to create a real-time interactive system where player input, motion, and rules continuously interact. The game aims to evoke curiosity, excitement, anticipation, and joy through physical/bodily movement, sound, colorful visuals, minimal instructionals, experiential friction, no-touch navigation, and the reward of winning, stimulating multiple senses at the same time.











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Catch all the eggssssss!!
by Tanaka Mapondera

mySketch.js × index.html style.css

```
160
161  //-----DRAW-----------------
162  function draw() {
163    // level progression (runs every frame)
164    if (gameState === 1 && eggBasket >= 1) gameState = 2;
165    if (gameState === 2 && eggBasket >= 15) gameState = 3;
166    if (gameState === 3 && eggBasket >= 20) gameState = 4;
167    if (gameState === 5 && eggBasket >= 1) gameState = 1;
168
169    // WIN/LOSE
170    if (eggBasket >= 40000) {
171      gameState = 6; // win
172    } else if (eggsMissed >= 5000) {
173      if (eggBasket >= 10000) gameState = 6; // win
174      else gameState = 7; // lose
175    }
176
177    // detect gameState change
178    if (gameState !== prevGameState) {
179      if (audioUnlocked) handleAudioForStateChange(gameState);
180      prevGameState = gameState;
181    }
182
183    switch (gameState) {
184      //----------------------CASE 1 HOMESCREEN----------------------
185      case 1:
186        background(220);
187
188        // MIRROR Mode
189        push();
190        translate(windowWidth, 0);
191        scale(-1, 1);
```

Catch all the eggssssss!!
by Tanaka Mapondera

mySketch.js × index.html style.css

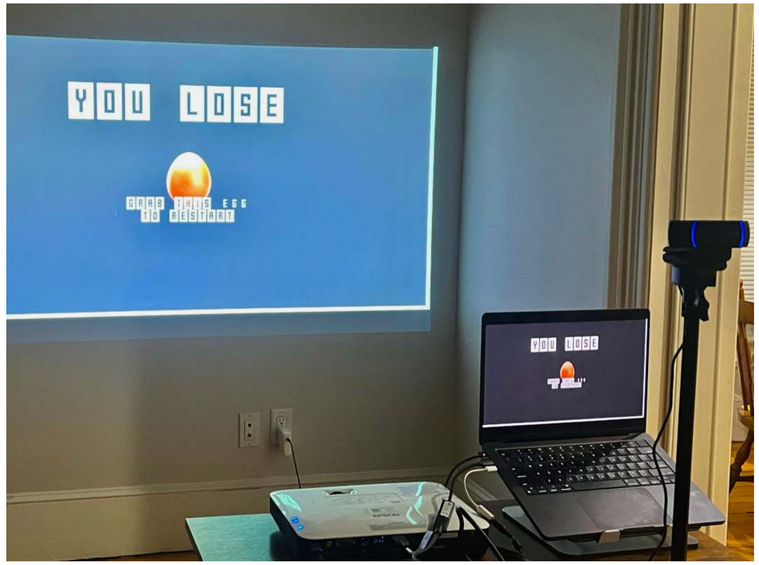
```
528      //----------------CASE 6 YOU WIN----------------
529      case 6:
530        background(random(0, 360), 50, 70);
531
532        // (your win screen bodypose code unchanged — keeping it short
533        fill(255);
534        textFont(gameFont);
535        textAlign(CENTER);
536        textSize(200);
537        text("you win!!!", windowWidth / 2, 300);
538
539        fill(255);
540        textSize(70);
541        text("grab this EGG", windowWidth / 2, 650);
542        text("to restart", windowWidth / 2, 700);
543
544        break;
545
546      //----------------CASE 7 YOU LOSE----------------
547      case 7:
548        background(20);
549
550        fill(255);
551        textFont(gameFont);
552        textAlign(CENTER);
553        textSize(200);
554        text("😿you lose😿", windowWidth / 2, 300);
555
556        fill(255);
557        textSize(70);
558        text("grab this EGG", windowWidth / 2, 650);
559        text("to restart", windowWidth / 2, 700);
```

Catch all the eggssssss!!
by Tanaka Mapondera

mySketch.js × index.html style.css

```
573  // EGGS Class
574  class EGG {
575    constructor(x, y, r, H, S, B, s) {
576      this.x = x;
577      this.y = y;
578      this.r = r;
579      this.H = H;
580      this.S = S;
581      this.B = B;
582      this.speed = s;
583    }
584
585    reset() {
586      this.y = -this.r - random(40, 100);
587      this.x = random(windowWidth);
588    }
589
590    update() {
591      this.y += this.speed;
592
593      if (this.y - this.r > height) {
594        eggsMissed++;
595        this.reset();
596      }
597    }
598
599    show() {
600      noStroke();
601      fill(this.H, this.S, this.B);
602      ellipse(this.x, this.y, this.r * 1.4, this.r * 2);
603    }
604  }
```





Catch the Eggs!, 2026

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Nocturna Music Festival

WORK: **Identity design**
Systems thinking
Synesthesia
Scale
Typography
Print
Publication

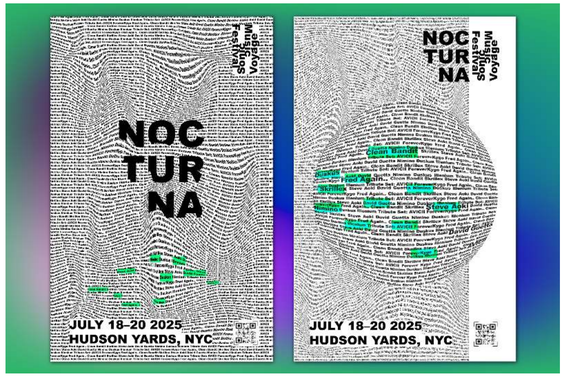
DATE: 2025

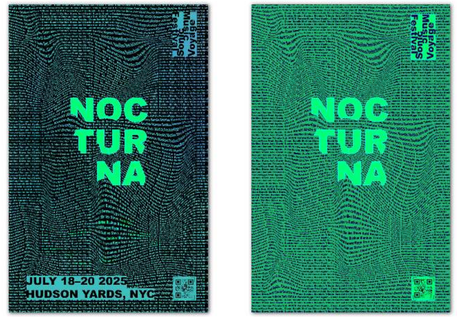
Typographic identity design for Nocturna, a music festival or sonic voyage concept I named and designed inspired by various house and electronic musicians/artists. Working on this project was challenging, but made me realize how much I love working with type as form. In this case, the form was in response to the music genres of this festival: deep house and electronic dance, blending emotive, atmospheric textures. I used accent color to highlight the lineup of the artists. All typeset in Arial Black.









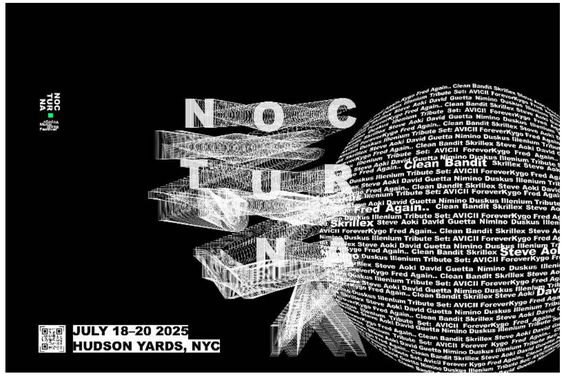






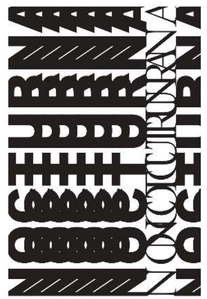


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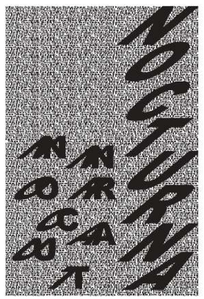


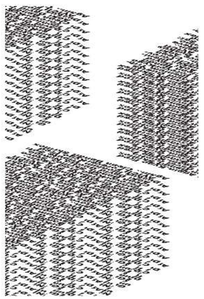




































Nocturna, 2025

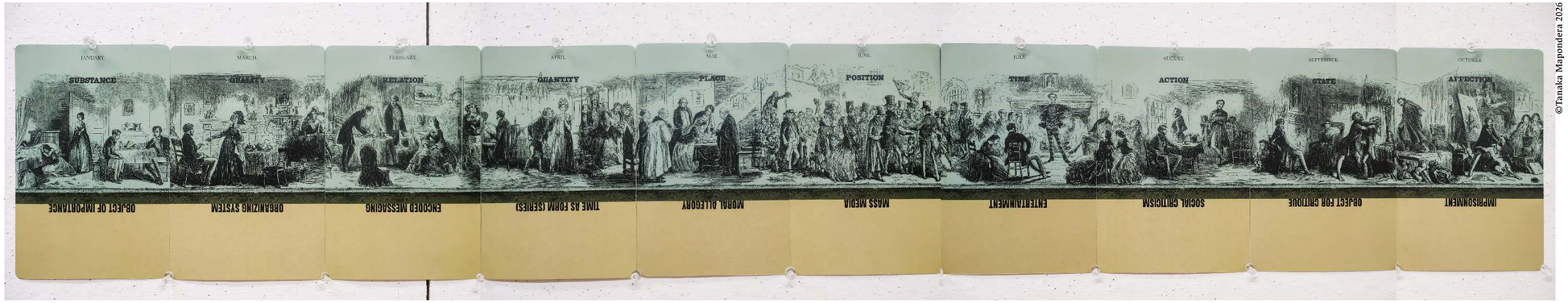
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Little Dorrit Plates

WORK: **Systems thinking**
Critical thinking
Typography
Publication design
Print
Archive

DATE: 2025

This project examines Charles Dickens' *Little Dorrit* as a material system rather than a literary text. Using a set of printed plates, I reinterpret the book as an archive of structures—binding codes, paper types, advertisements, and serial formats—revealing how meaning is produced through both content and construction. Each plate presents "evidence" on the front and interpretation on the reverse, guiding the viewer from database to narrative while foregrounding themes of containment, circulation, and social critique.



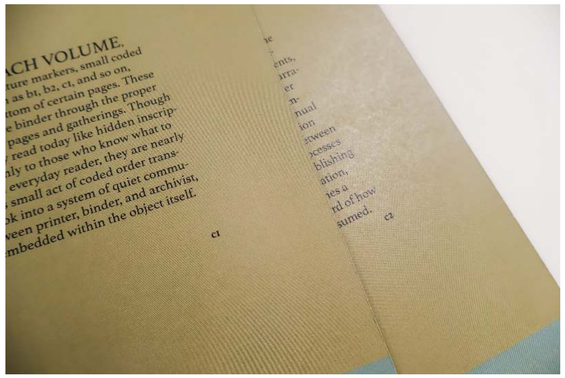
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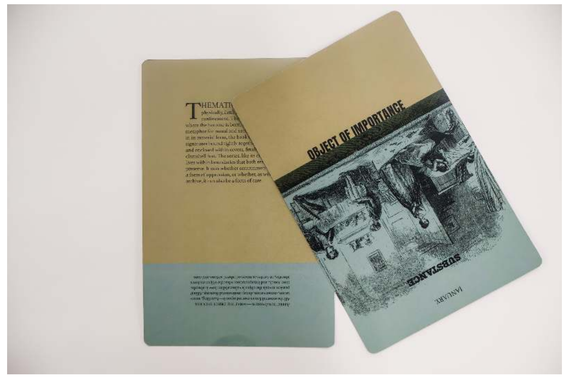














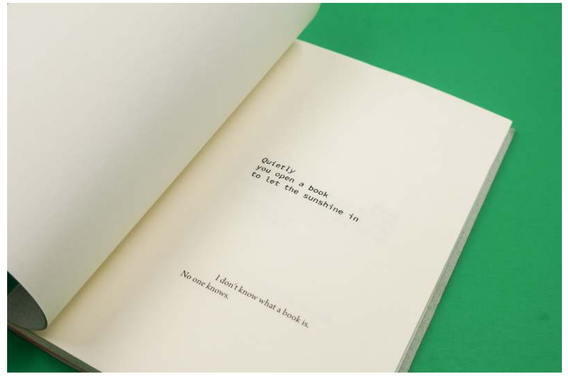
Melody / Chorus

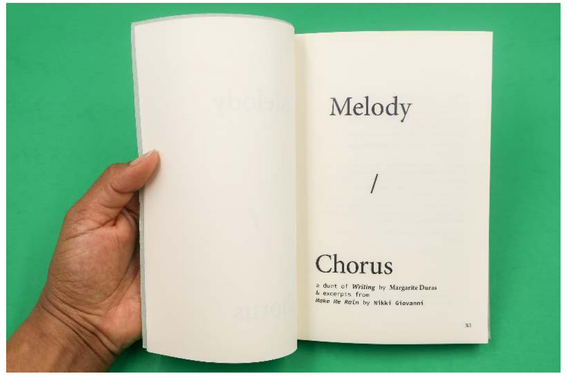
WORK: **Publication design**
Multiple voices
Typography
Experimental typography
Book binding

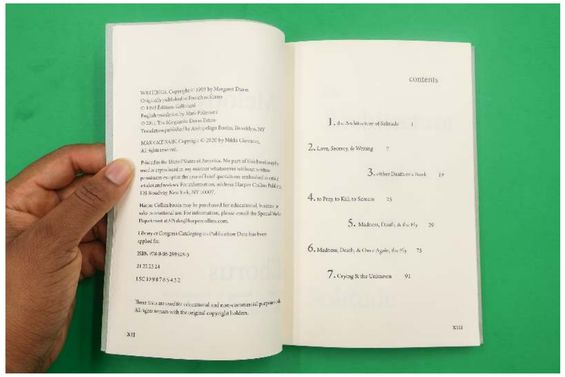
DATE: 2025

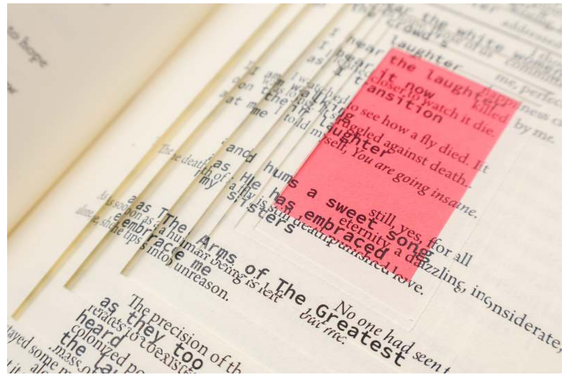
A typographic duet exploring solitude, grief, and the act of writing through the interwoven voices of Marguerite Duras (serif) and Nikki Giovanni (monospaced). Through pacing, silence, and spatial composition, the book transforms typesetting into an atmospheric experience—where reading becomes slow, intimate, and deeply felt.

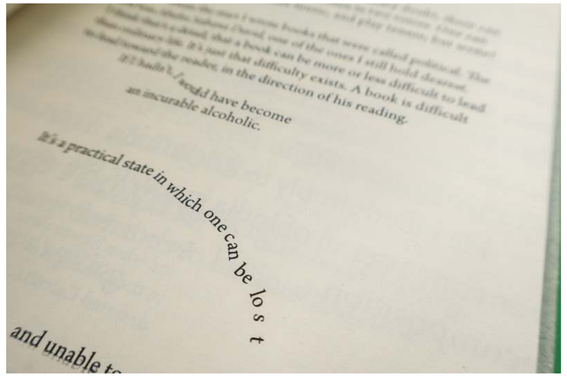


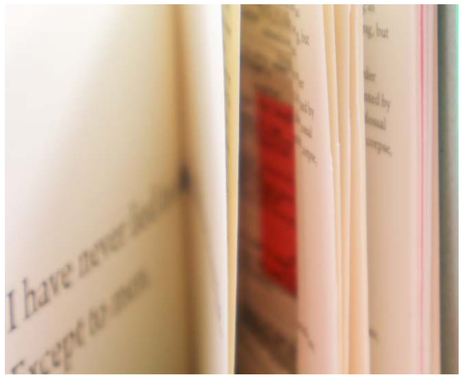




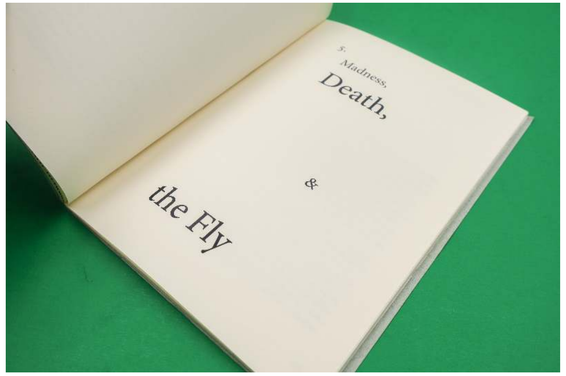








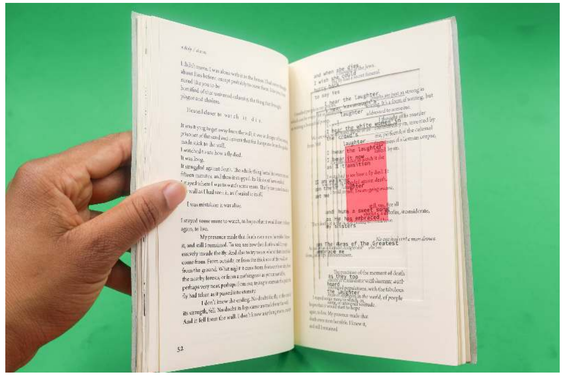


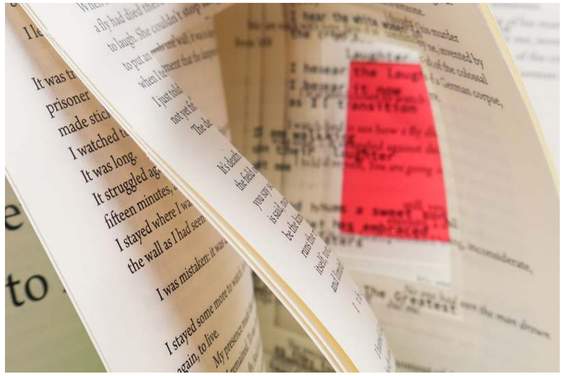


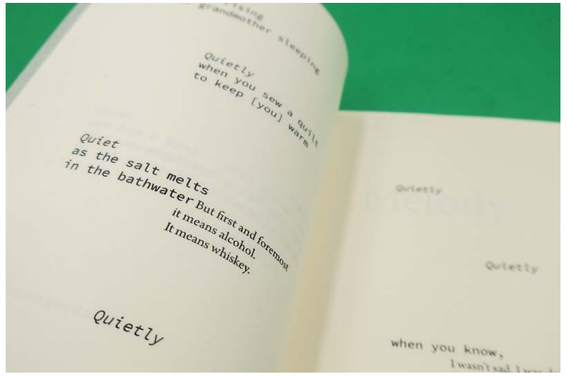


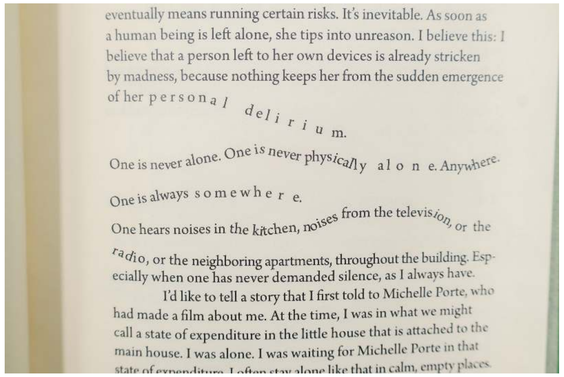
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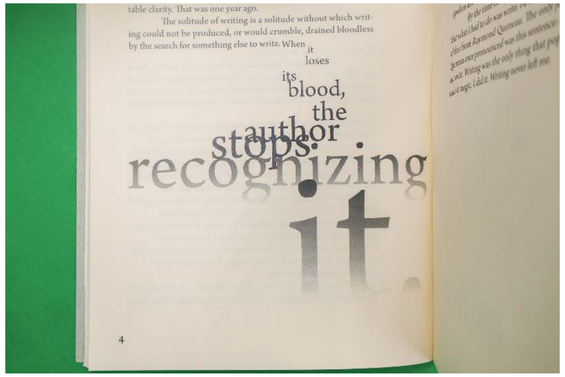


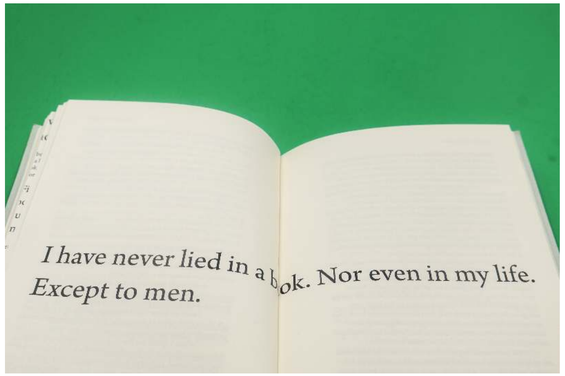


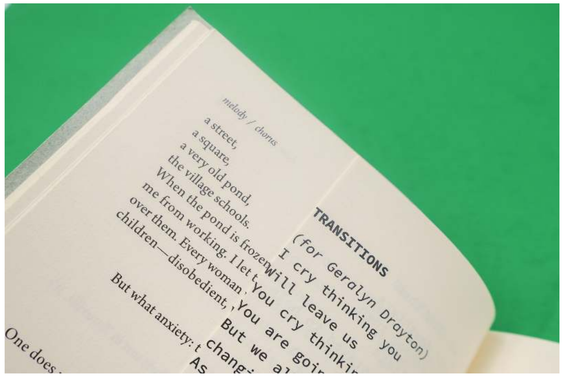


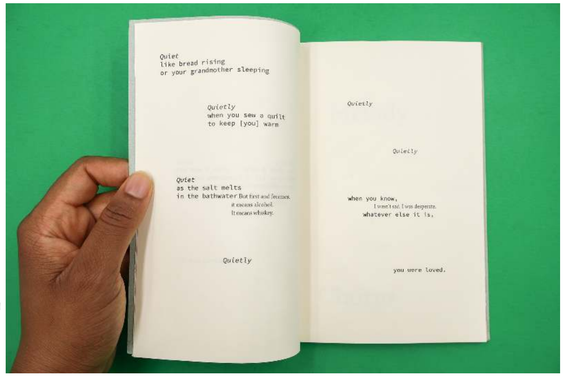






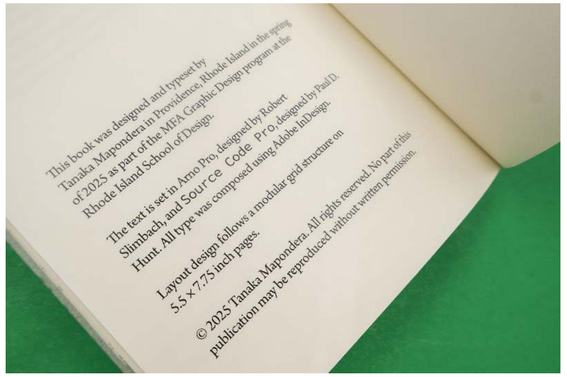












Melody / Chorus, 2025

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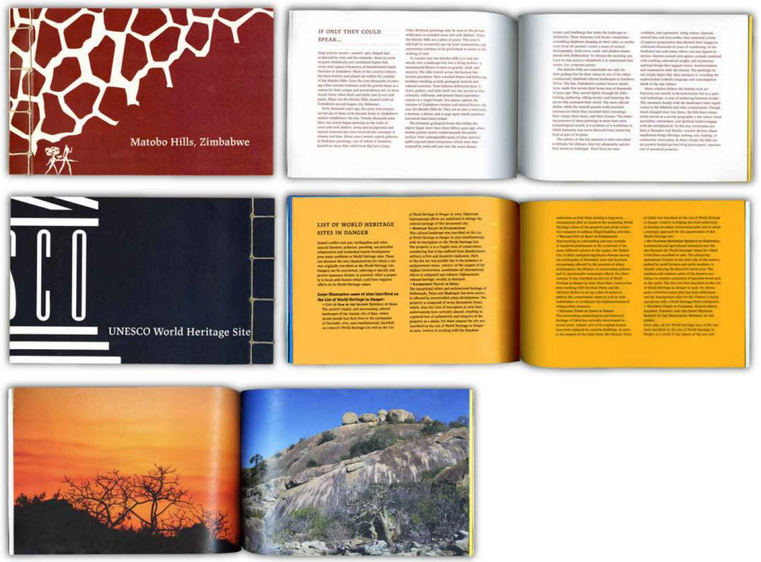
Matobo Hills Identity

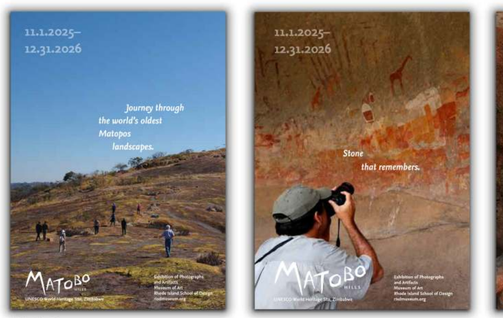
WORK: Identity design
Systems thinking
Naming
Scale
Typography
Print
Publication design
Book binding

DATE: 2025

An identity system that engages Matobo Hills as both landscape and living archive. Drawing from its rock formations, ritual sites, and visual histories, the project investigates how design can hold memory, spirituality, and time—translating a sacred cultural terrain into a responsive visual language.







Tanaka Mapondera | RISD 2025
Advisors: Doug Scott & Deborah Khodanovich

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IsiNdebele

Amadwala amakhulu e-granite — agoqekileyo, ahlukanisisiwe, abunjwe yisikhathi lezinto zemvelo — akha uchungechunge lwamatshe amakhulu afana lamadolo enhlanzi kanye lamadwala afana lamabhilikhwe, agoqe indawo engange-3000 square kilometres eMatabeleland South. Inengi lomlando welizwe lilotshiwe njalo lidlalelwe phakathi kwala madwala eMatobo — kusukela kudala kakhulu izinkulungwane zeminyaka eyadlulayo lapho abantu bakudala, amaBushmen, basebenzisa ubuso bamadwala njengephepha lobuciko babo obuhlukileyo lobumangalisayo, kuze kufike izikhathi zakamuva lapho abamnyama labamhlophe behlangana khona phakathi kwempi lokuthula.

Yila yiMatobo Hills, ezansi kwedolobho lesibili ngobukhulu eZimbabwe, iBulawayo. Eminyakeni engaphezu kwengu-40 000 edluleyo, imihubhe lemifantu emadwaleni yaba yindawo yokuhlala yabantu bokuqala baseZimbabwe — amaSan. Eminyakeni engu-20 000 kamuva, abadwebi beSan baqala ukudweba ezindongeni zemihubhe leminyathelo yamadwala, besebenzisa upende olukhethekileyo lemaminerali emvelo akwazi ukumelana lesikhathi lezimo zemkhathi.

Imihubhe eminengi igcwele imidwebo yeBushman emangalisayo, enye yayo inguBambata, ekungasiyo kude kakhulu — cishe i-10km — leBig Cave Camp. Eminye imidwebo yeBushman ingatholakala ezindaweni ezizimeleyo zemvelo, efihliwe emihubhe lemboloko yamadwala.

Lamuhla iMatobo Hills yindawo yokuthula; kodwa indawo le isabukwa ngenhlonipho enkulu ngumphakathi, njalo imicimbi isaqhutshwa ukuze kusizwe ekuletheni izulu.

ChiShona

Mapani makuru egirinayiti — akachekwa, akapwanyika, akavezwa nenguva nezvinhu zvakasikwa — anoumba makomo akafanana nemapfupa chove huru uye mapako akaita sematower, zvichivhara nzvimbo inosvika makiromita mazana matatu emuMatabeleland South. Zvizhinji zvenyika izvi zvakanyorwa uye zvikaitika mukati memakomo eMatobo — kubva kare-kare zviuru zvemakore apfuura apo vanhu vekare, maBushmen, vaishandisa matombo aya semapanera epfeka mabasa avo anoshamisa, kusvika munguva dzepedyo apo vatema nevachena vakasangana murunyararo nehurwa.

Aya ndiwo Makomo eMatobo, ari kumaodzanyemba kweguta rechipiri pakukura muZimbabwe, Bulawayo. Makore anopfuura zviuru makumi mana apfuura, mapako nemakaha akayezwa mumatombo aya akava imba yekugara kwevanhu vekutanga muZimbabwe — vaSan. Makore zviuru makumi maviri gare gare, vaSan vakatanga kupenda parnadziro emapako nemaimba ematombo vachishandisa maphuramu akakosha nemaminerari echisikigo akakwanisa kumira kumeso kwenguva nemamiriro ekunze.

Mapako mazhinji ane mifananidzo yakaisvonaka yeBushman, kusanganisira rimwe riri kuBamvabata, riri pedyo neBig Cave Camp zvinenge 10km. Mifananidzo yeBushman inogonawo kuwanikwa munzvimbo dzakavigwa dzesango rakazvimirira mumapako nemakaha akavanzika.

Nhasi, Makomo eMatobo inzvimbo yerunyararo; zvisinei, nzvimbo iyi ichiri kuchengetedzwa neruremekedzo rukuru nemunharaunda, uye mhemberero dzichiri kuitwa dzinokumbira kuti mvura inaye.

中文

巨大的花岗岩体 — 被间和自然力量切割、裂开、塑形与雕刻 — 形成了一系列巨大的脊状山体和城堡般的丘陵，覆盖了马塔贝贝莱南省三千平方公里的土地。个国家的多史都在马托博丘陵之间写下并上演 — 从数千年前古代布曼人将花岩表面当作画布作他独特而非凡的艺开始，一直到近代黑人与白人在争与和平中相遇。

里就是马托博丘陵，位于津巴布韦第二大城市布拉瓦以南。四万年前，些岩石中由自然雕刻出的洞穴与陵成津巴布韦最早居民 — 桑人 — 的家园。两万年后，桑族艺家开始在洞穴和岩石庇护所的墙壁上作画，使用特别的料和天然物，些作品经受住了间与气候的侵。

多洞穴收藏着精美的布曼岩画，其中包括距离*Big Cave Camp*不超公里的斑巴塔洞穴。其他布曼岩画可在私人荒野中的秘洞穴和岩石庇护所中看到。

如今，马托博丘陵是一片和平之地；然而，当地社区仍片土地怀有深深的敬意，并持行祈雨仪式。

English

Huge granite masses — seamed, split, shaped and sculptured by time and the elements — form an array of giant whalebacks and castellated kopjes that cover 3000 square kilometers of Matabeleland South Province. Much of the country's history has been written and played out within the confines of the Matobo Hills — from the time thousands of years ago when ancient bushmen used the granite faces as a canvas for their unique and extraordinary art, to more recent times, when black and white met in war and peace.

These are the Matobo Hills, located south of Zimbabwe's second largest city, Bulawayo. Forty thousand years ago the caves and crevices carved out of these rocks became home to Zimbabwe's earliest inhabitants, the *San*. Twenty thousand years later San artists began painting on the walls of caves and rock shelters, using special pigments and natural minerals that have survived the onslaught of climate and time.

Many caves contain superb galleries of Bushman paintings, one of which is Bambata, located no more than 10km from Big Cave Camp. Other Bushman paintings may be seen on the private wilderness in secluded caves and rock shelters.

Today the Matobo Hills are a place of peace; however this area is still held in reverential awe by local communities and ceremonies continue to be performed to assist in the making of rain.

Русский

Огромные гранитные массивы — иссечённые, расколотые, сформированные и выточенные временем и стихиями — образуют череду гигантских "спин китов" и зубчатых копий, покрывающих 3000 квадратных километров провинции Матабелеленд Юг. Большая часть истории страны была написана и разыграна в пределах Холмов Матобо — начиная с тех времён, когда тысячи лет назад древние бушмены использовали гранитные поверхности как полотно для своего уникального и необыкновенного искусства, и вплоть до более недавних времён, когда чёрные и белые сталкивались здесь в войне и мире.

Это — Холмы Матобо, расположенные к югу от второго по величине города Зимбабве, Булавайо. Сорок тысяч лет назад пещеры и расщелины, выдолбленные в этих скалах, стали домом для первых жителей Зимбабве — народа сан. Двадцать тысяч лет спустя художники сан начали расписывать стены пещер и скальных убежищ, используя особые пигменты и природные минералы, которые сумели пережить воздействие времени и климата.

Во многих пещерах хранятся великолепные галереи наскальных рисунков бушменов, среди них — Бамбата, расположенная менее чем в 10 км от лагеря Big Cave Camp. Другие рисунки бушменов можно увидеть в частных диких местах, в уединённых пещерах и скальных убежищах.

Сегодня Холмы Матобо — место мира; однако эта территория по-прежнему окружена глубоким почтением со стороны местных общин, и здесь всё ещё проводятся церемонии, призванные помочь вызвать дождь.

Français

D'énormes masses de granit — striées, fendues, façonnées et sculptées par le temps et les éléments — forment une série d'immenses dos de baleines et de kopjes crénelés qui couvrent 3000 kilomètres carrés dans la province du Matabeleland Sud. Une grande partie de l'histoire du pays s'est écrite et jouée au sein des collines du Matobo — depuis des millénaires, lorsque les anciens bushmen utilisaient les parois de granit comme toile pour leur art unique et extraordinaire, jusqu'à des temps plus récents, lorsque Noirs et Blancs se sont rencontrés en guerre comme en paix.

Voici les collines du Matobo, situées au sud de la deuxième plus grande ville du Zimbabwe, Bulawayo. Il y a quarante mille ans, les grottes et crevasses sculptées dans ces rochers devinrent la demeure des premiers habitants du pays, les San. Vingt mille ans plus tard, des artistes san commencèrent à peindre sur les parois des grottes et abris rocheux, utilisant des pigments spéciaux et des minéraux naturels qui ont résisté aux ravages du climat et du temps.

De nombreuses grottes renferment de superbes galeries de peintures bushmen, dont celle de Bambata, située à moins de 10 km de Big Cave Camp. D'autres peintures bushmen peuvent être observées dans la nature privée, dans des grottes et abris isolés.

Aujourd'hui, les collines du Matobo sont un lieu de paix; cependant, cette région est toujours entourée d'un profond respect par les communautés locales, et des cérémonies y sont encore pratiquées pour favoriser l'arrivée de la pluie.

Spanish

Enormes masas de granito — surcadas, divididas, moldeadas y esculpidas por el tiempo y los elementos — forman una serie de gigantescas dorsales y kopjes almenados que cubren 3000 kilómetros cuadrados de la provincia de Matabeleland South. Gran parte de la historia del país se ha escrito y desarrollado dentro de los límites de las Colinas de Matobo — desde hace miles de años, cuando los antiguos bosquimanos utilizaron las superficies graníticas como lienzo para su arte único y extraordinario, hasta tiempos más recientes, cuando negros y blancos se encontraron en guerra y en paz.

Estas son las Colinas de Matobo, situadas al sur de la segunda ciudad más grande de Zimbabue, Bulawayo. Hace cuarenta mil años, las cuevas y grietas talladas en estas rocas se convirtieron en el hogar de los primeros habitantes del país, los san. Veinte mil años después, artistas san comenzaron a pintar en las paredes de cuevas y refugios rocosos, utilizando pigmentos especiales y minerales naturales que han sobrevivido a los estragos del clima y del tiempo.

Muchas cuevas contienen magníficas galerías de pinturas bosquimanas, entre ellas Bambata, ubicada a no más de 10 km de Big Cave Camp. Otras pinturas bosquimanas pueden verse en áreas silvestres privadas, en cuevas y refugios aislados.

Hoy en día, las Colinas de Matobo son un lugar de paz; sin embargo, esta zona aún es venerada con profundo respeto por las comunidades locales, y continúan realizándose ceremonias para pedir lluvia.

العربية

كتل صخرية من الغرانيت — مشققة، ومنقسمة، ومشكّلة ومنحوتة بفعل الزمن والعوامل الطبيعية — تكوّن صفوفاً من التلال الصخرية الشبيهة بظهور الحيتان والتلال الصخرية المسنّنة التي تغطي ثلثَي آلاف كيلومتر مربع من مقاطعة ماتابيليلاند الجنوبية. وقد كُتب الكثير من تاريخ البلاد وتجلّى داخل حدود جبال ماتوبو — منذ آلاف السنين حين استخدم رجال الأدغال القدماء أسطح الغرانيت كقماش لفنّهم الفريد والاستثنائي، وحتى الأزمنة الحديثة، حين التقى السود والبيض في الحرب والسلام.

هذه هي جبال ماتوبو، الواقعة جنوب ثاني أكبر مدينة في زيمبابوي، بولاوايو. منذ أربعين ألف سنة، أصبحت الكهوف والشقوق المنحوتة في هذه الصخور موطناً لأقدم سكان زيمبابوي، وهم شعب السان. وبعد عشرين ألف سنة، بدأ فنانو السان في الرسم على جدران الكهوف والملاجئ الصخرية مستخدمين أصباغاً خاصة وعناصر طبيعية صمدت أمام قسوة المُناخ والمناخ.

تحتوي العديد من الكهوف على معارض رائعة من رسومات البوشمان، ومن بينها كهف بامباتا، الذي لا يبعد أكثر من 10 كيلومترات عن معسكر Big Cave. ويمكن مشاهدة رسومات أخرى للبوشمان في المناطق البرية الخاصة، داخل كهوف ومخابئ صخرية معزولة.

اليوم تُعد جبال ماتوبو مكاناً للسلام؛ ومع ذلك، ما زالت هذه المنطقة تحظى بإجلال كبير من المجتمعات المحلية، وما زالت طقوس تقام فيها طلباً لنزول المطر.

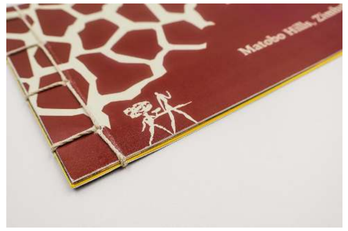


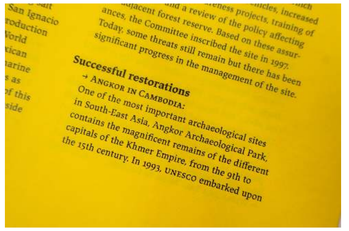














Matobo Hills Identity, 2025

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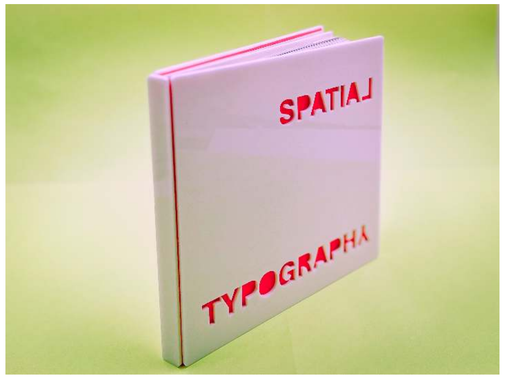
Spatial Typography

WORK: **Publication design**
Spatial design
Typography
Experimental typography
Interpretive/content-dictated publication
Book binding

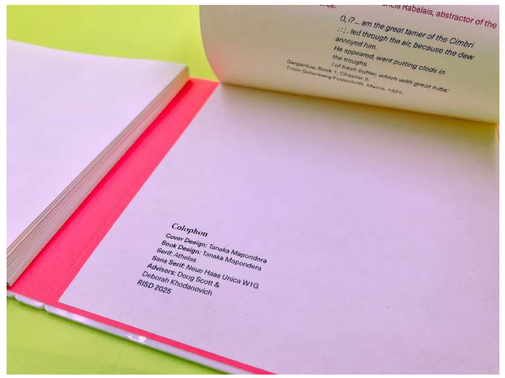
DATE: 2025

This publication is an artist book examining El Lissitzky's spatial typographic principles through contemporary book design that responds to subject matter. The work tests how typography behaves when treated as a 3-dimensional object rather than a 2D surface. Together with two example works by Lissitzky, the publication features appropriately selected works exploring spatial typography by some of my favorite artists and designers like es devlin, Stefan Sagmeister, Jaume Plensar and more.

This artist-book is hand-bound with a laser-cut cover, incorporating variable opening structures that allow the pages to stand, extend, and collapse, creating a kinetic reading event. It serves both as a reading experience and a collectible, 3D-art object that treats typography as architecture: words, pages, and folds create shifting planes and viewpoints, so the narrative changes as the object is manipulated.







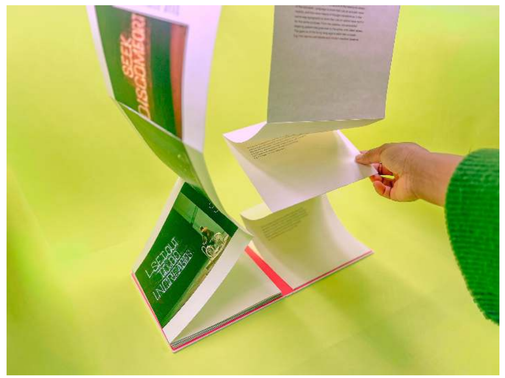






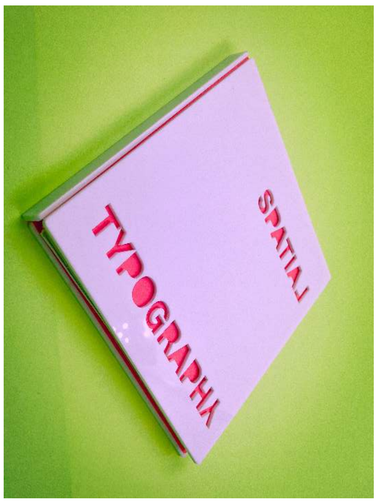






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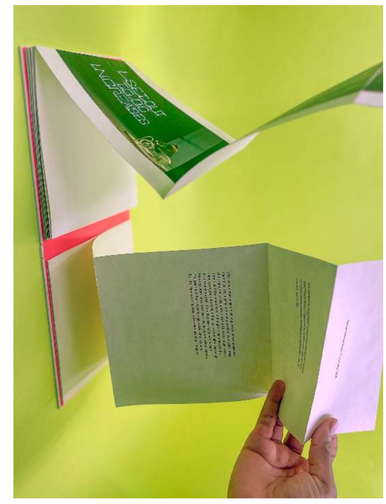
Spatial Typography, 2025

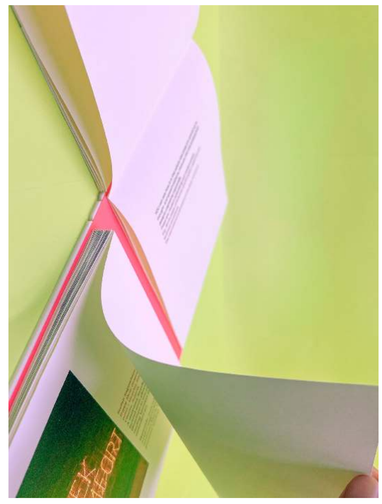














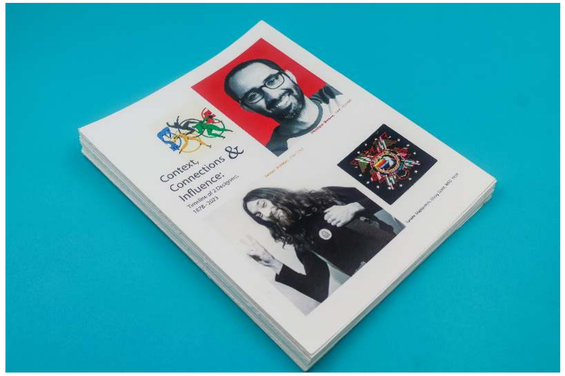
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Timeline of 2 Designers

WORK: **Information design**
Typography
Publication
Print
Book binding

DATE: 2024

A research-driven timeline mapping key moments in animation, design, and visual culture—from Barney Bubbles to Henrique Barone—tracing how technological shifts, platforms, and independent creators have reshaped the medium from the mid-20th century to the present.



















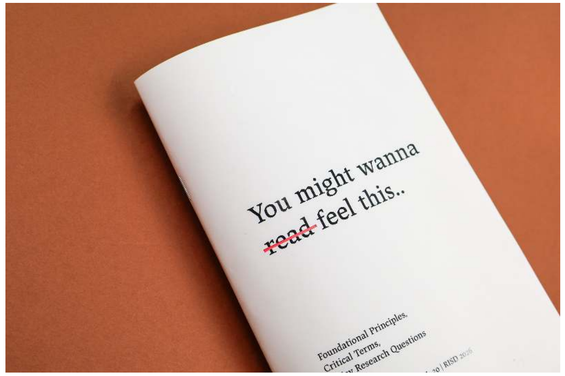


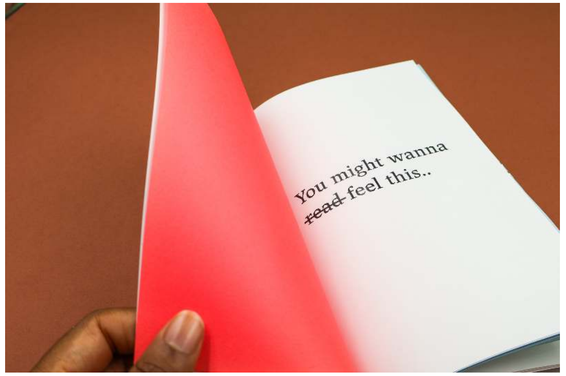
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Experiemental Typography + Publication

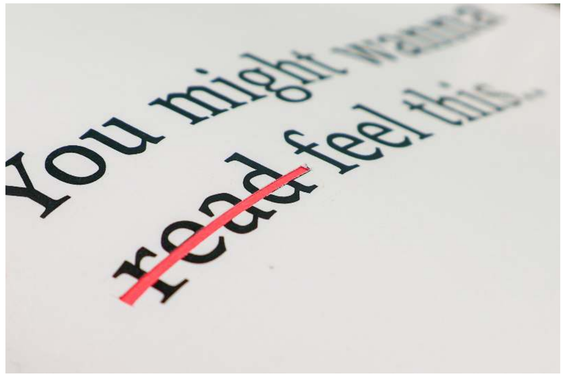
WORK: Publication design
Typography
Experimental typography
Interpretive/content-dictated publication
Book binding

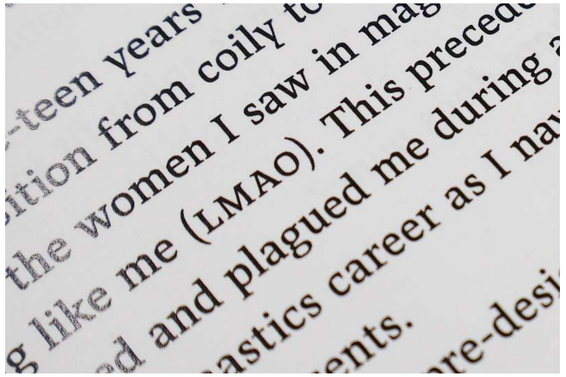
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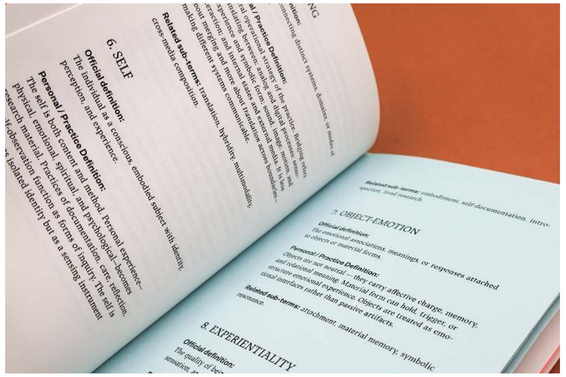






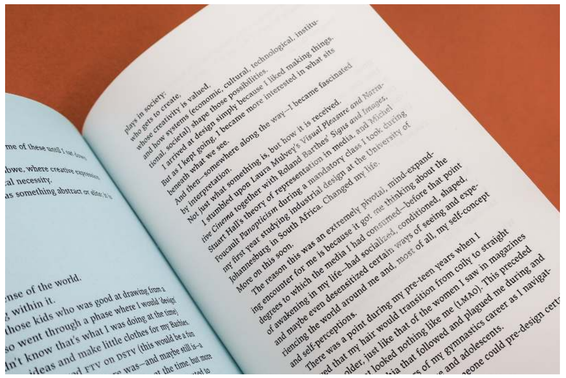








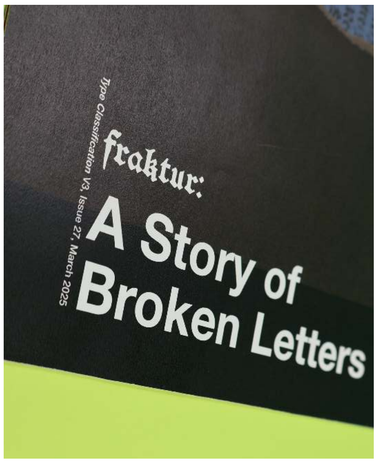






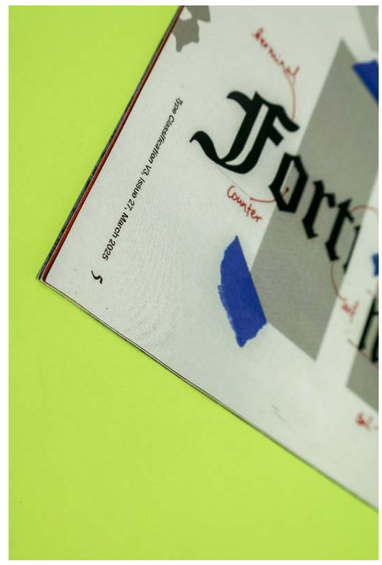
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Experiemental Typography + Publication, 2026–2024





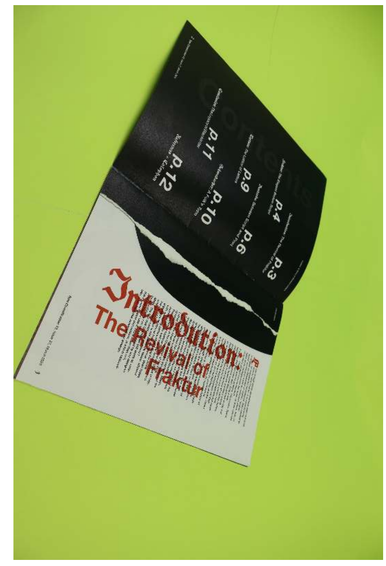
















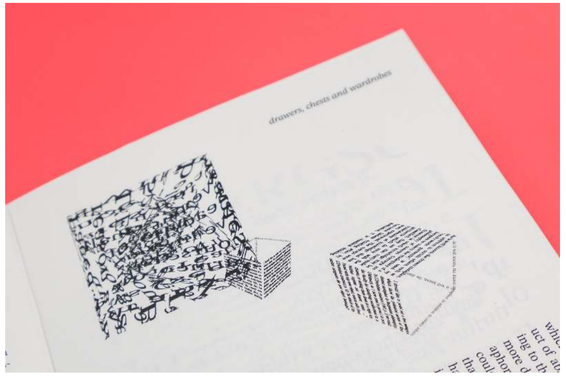


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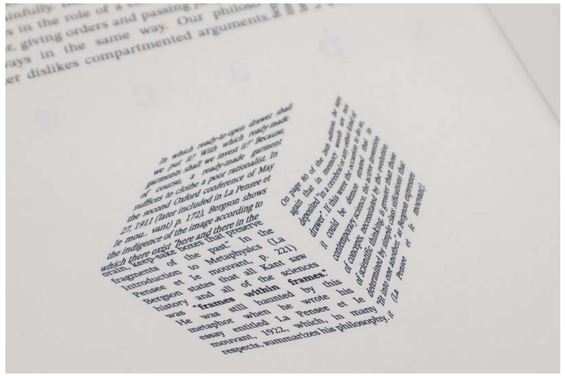
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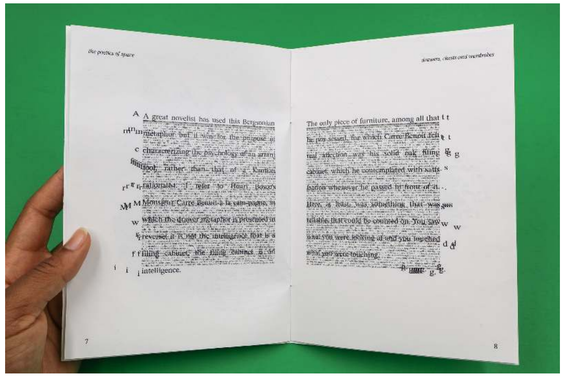


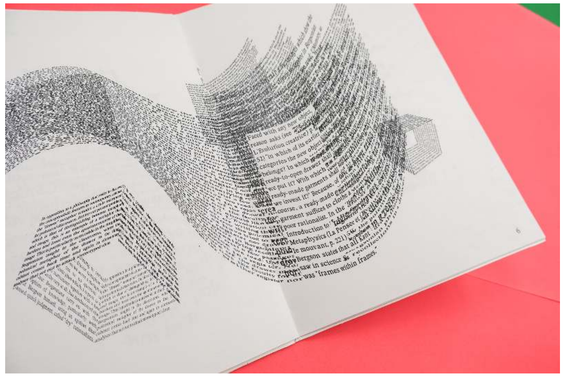




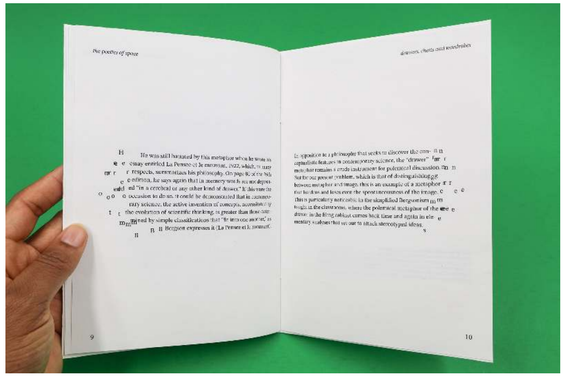


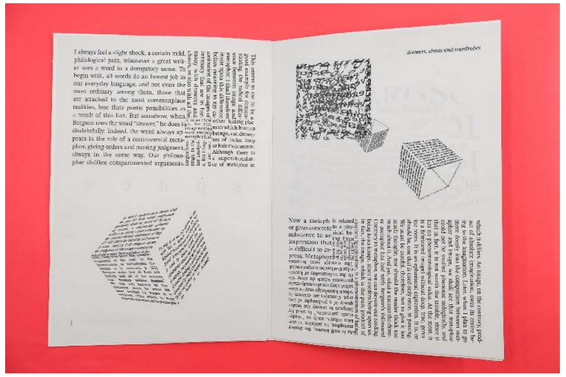


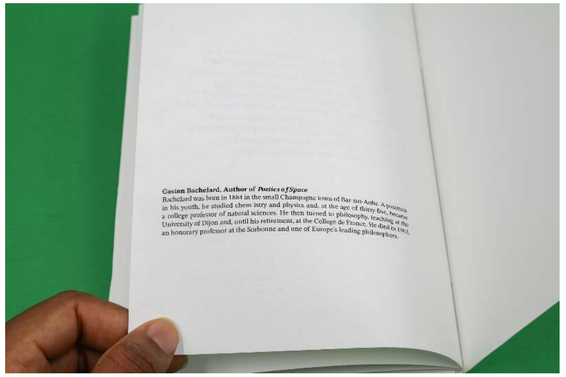










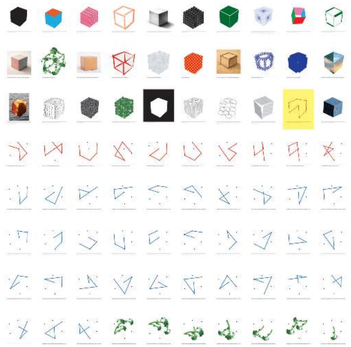


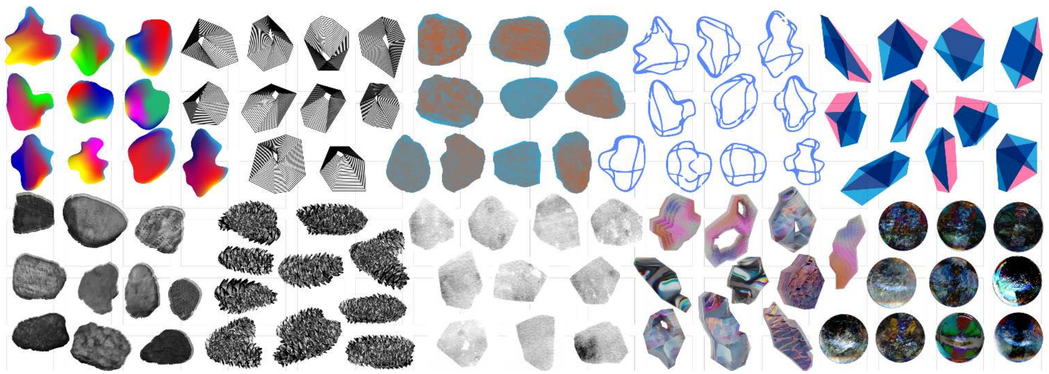
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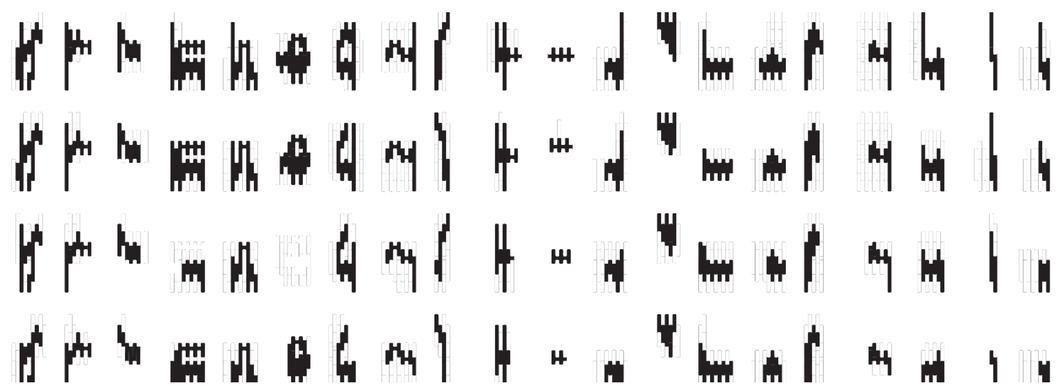
Generative Variant Form Studies

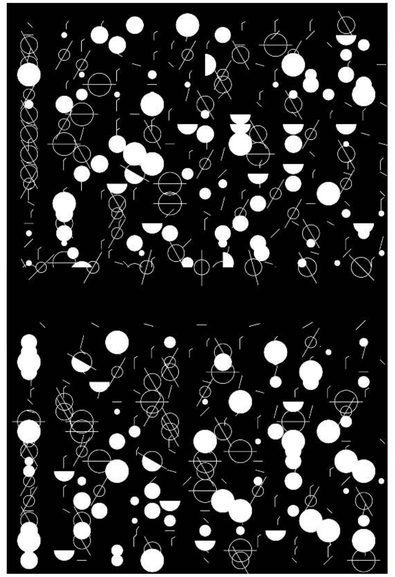
WORK: Generative design
Systems thinking
Rule-based design
Ideation
Drawing with light
Photography
Analog + digital
Print

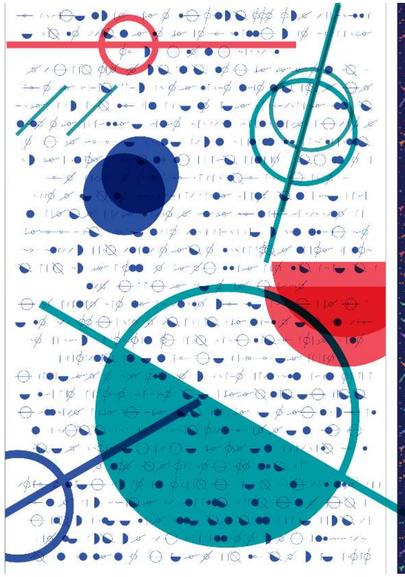
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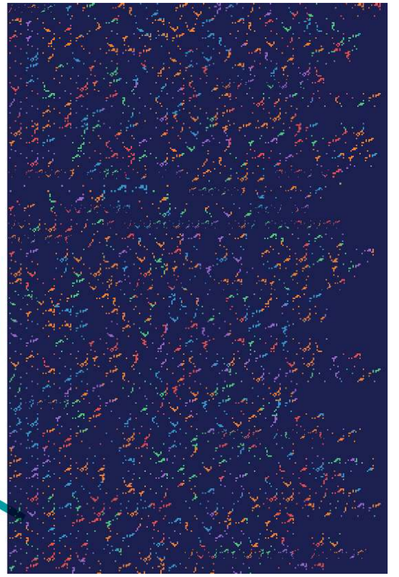


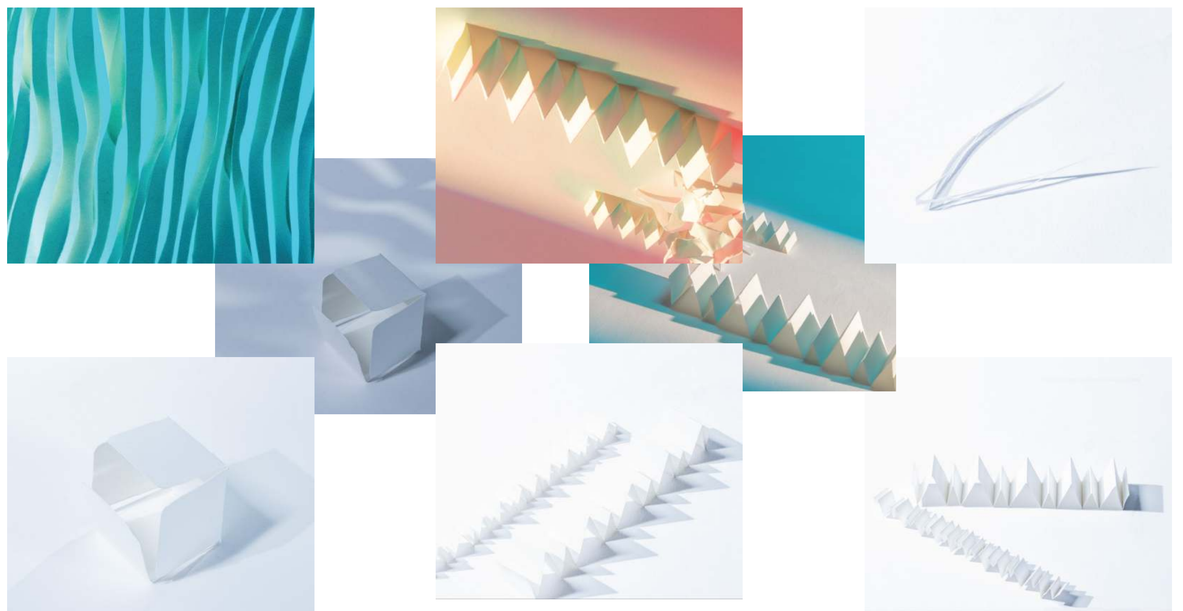






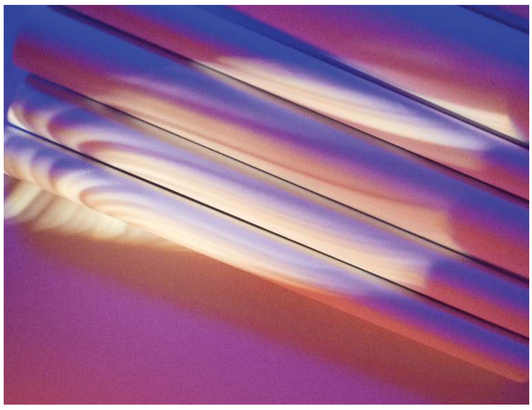


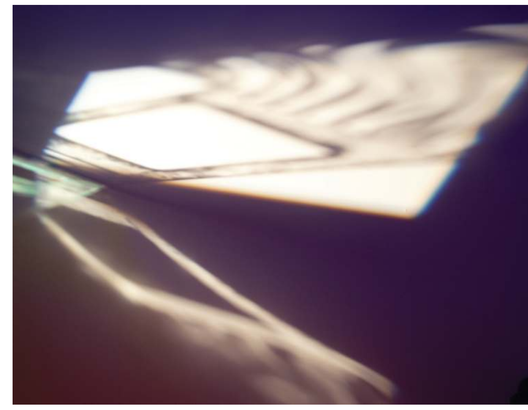




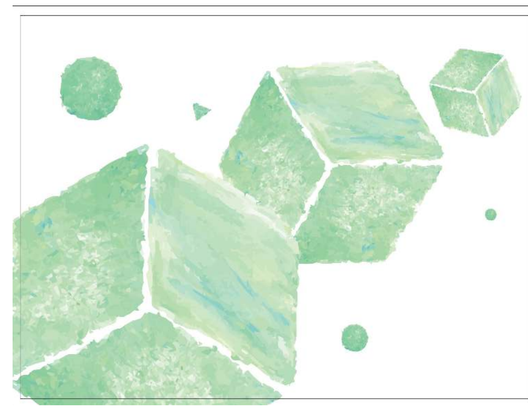
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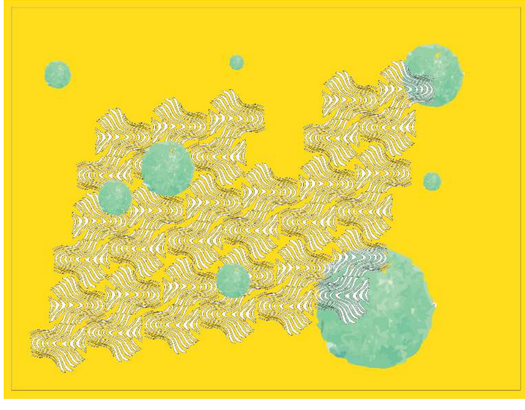
Generative Variant Form Studies





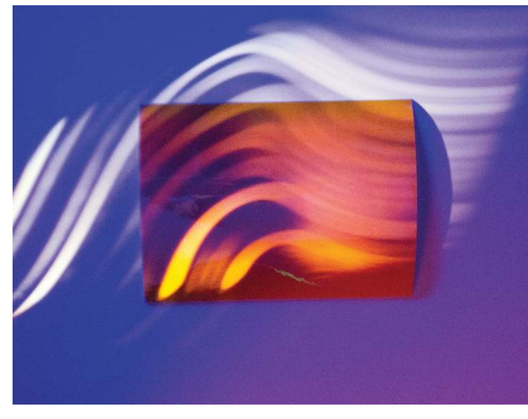












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